

Horizon Europe Programme

Standard Application Form (HE EIC STEP)

Application form (Part A)
Project proposal – Technical description (Part B)

Version 1.0
26 November 2024

Application form (Part A)

Example, not to be completed

Please check our wiki for help on navigating the form.

Horizon Europe

Application forms (Part A)

Topic:

Type of action:

Type of Model Grant Agreement:

Proposal number:

Proposal acronym:

Example, not to be completed

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Section	*Title*	*Action*
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The forms must be filled in for each proposal using the templates available in the Submission System. Some data fields in the forms are pre-filled based on the previous steps in the Submission wizard.

This proposal version was submitted by [Name, FAMILY NAME] on [dd/mm/yyyy HH:mm:ss] Brussels Local Time. Issued by the Funding and Tenders Portal Submission Service

1 – General information

Section 1 provides basic data on the proposal. It can be filled in by contacts of the coordinator. Other participants may view this section only. Read-only parts are marked in blue.

Topic	Type of action
Call	Type of Model Grant Agreement

Acronym	*Acronym is mandatory*
Proposal title	*Max 200 characters (with spaces). Must be understandable for non-specialists in your field.*

Note that for technical reasons, the following characters are not accepted in the Proposal Title and will be removed: < > " &

Duration in months	*Estimated duration of the project in full months.*
Fixed keywords	

Note that for this call, applicants have to select minimum 3 and maximum 6 fixed keywords.

Free keywords	*Enter any words you think give extra detail of the scope of your proposal (max 200 characters with spaces).*

Abstract

The abstract should provide the reader with a clear understanding of the objectives of the proposal, how they will be achieved, and their relevance to the Work Programme. This summary will be used as the short description of the proposal in the evaluation process and in communications to the programme management committees and other interested parties. It must therefore be short and precise and should not contain confidential information. Use plain typed text, avoiding formulas and other special characters. If the proposal is written in a language other than English, please include an English version of this abstract in the Part B (technical description) of the proposal. .

Example, not to be completed

Has this proposal (or a very similar one) been submitted in the past 2 years in response to a call for proposals under any EU programme, including the current call? *A `similar' proposal or contract is one that differs from the current one in minor ways, and in which some of the present consortium members are involved.*	○ Yes	○ No
Please give the proposal reference or contract number	XXXXX-X	

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Declarations

These declarations can be filled in by any coordinator contact(s). All declarations are mandatory.

1) We declare to have the explicit consent of all applicants on their participation and on the content of this proposal.	☐
2) We confirm that the information contained in this proposal is correct and complete and that none of the project activities have started before the proposal was submitted (unless explicitly authorised in the call conditions).	☐
3) We declare: – to be fully compliant with the eligibility criteria set out in the call – not to be subject to any exclusion grounds under the EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046 – to have the financial and operational capacity to carry out the proposed project.	☐
4) We acknowledge that all communication will be made through the Funding & Tenders Portal electronic exchange system and that access and use of this system is subject to the Funding & Tenders Portal Terms & Conditions.	☐
5) We have read, understood and accepted the Funding & Tenders Portal Terms & Conditions and Privacy Statement that set out the conditions of use of the Portal and the scope, purposes, retention periods, etc. for the processing of personal data of all data subjects whose data we communicate for the purpose of the application, evaluation, award and subsequent management of our grant, prizes and contracts (including financial transactions and audits).	☐
6) We declare that the proposal complies with ethical principles (including the highest standards of research integrity as set out in the ALLEA European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity, as well as applicable international and national law, including the Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union and the European Convention on Human Rights and its Supplementary Protocols. Appropriate procedures, policies and structures are in place to foster responsible research practices, to prevent questionable research practices and research misconduct, and to handle allegations of breaches of the principles and standards in the Code of Conduct.	☐
7) We declare that the proposal has an exclusive focus on civil applications (activities intended to be used in military application or aiming to serve military purposes cannot be funded). If the project involves dual-use items in the sense of Regulation 2021/821, or other items for which authorisation is required, we confirm that we will comply with the applicable regulatory framework (e.g. obtain export/import licences before these items are used).	☐
8) We confirm that the activities proposed do not – aim at human cloning for reproductive purposes; – intend to modify the genetic heritage of human beings which could make such changes heritable (with the exception of research relating to cancer treatment of the gonads, which may be financed), or – intend to create human embryos solely for the purpose of research or for the purpose of stem cell procurement, including by means of somatic cell nuclear transfer. – lead to the destruction of human embryos (for example, for obtaining stem cells) These activities are excluded from funding.	☐
9) We confirm that for activities carried out outside the Union, the same activities would have been allowed in at least one EU Member State.	☐
10) *[Additional option for LUMP SUM Grants:* For Lump Sum Grants with a detailed budget table: We understand and accept that the EU lump sum grants must be reliable proxies for the actual costs of a project and confirm that the detailed budget for the proposal has been established in accordance with our usual cost accounting practices and in compliance with the basic eligibility conditions for EU actual cost grants (see *AGA — Annotated Grant Agreement, art 6*) and exclude costs that are ineligible under the Programme. Purchases and subcontracting costs must be done taking into	☐

Example not to be completed

account best value for money and must be free of conflict of interest.]	

The coordinator is only responsible for the information relating to their own organisation. Each applicant remains responsible for the information declared for their organisation. If the proposal is retained for EU funding, they will all be required to sign a declaration of honour.

False statements or incorrect information may lead to administrative sanctions under the EU Financial Regulation.

Example, not to be completed

2 – Participants

List of participating organisations

#	Participating Organisation Legal Name	Country
1		
2		
3		

Coordinator contacts have the rights to:

- *add, delete, edit and re-order partners in the consortium*
- *add, delete, edit and re-order contact points for those organisations*
- *edit all sections of the administrative forms*
- *upload, delete, view and download Part B and Annexes (when required for the call)*
- *submit the proposal*

Participant contacts may:

- *view all the information in this screen, but not edit it*
- *edit only the section for their organisation in the administrative forms (including budget)*
- *view the entire administrative forms*
- *view/download the Part B and other Annexes*

You can manage the list of organisations and access rights of persons at Step 4 of the submission process. You may identify and give access to as many contact persons of the selected organisations as you wish. The identification is based upon the e-mail address of the person. When you add a contact person, you will be prompted to supply the contact details: name, e-mail, phone.

Person in charge of the proposal (main contact person): Each organisation needs to have one main contact person identified; the main contact person will have to fill in full contact details in the administrative form. The 'Main Contact Person' for the coordinating organisation (Participant no. 1) will become the primary contact person for the Services. Other contact persons may also be identified and may receive read-only or full access rights. Contact persons with full access rights of the coordinator (Participant no. 1) will be called 'Coordinator contacts' in the Funding & Tenders Portal, while for the other participants 'Participant Contacts'; contact persons with read-only rights will be called 'Team Members'. Other contact persons are listed with basic details in the administrative form.

Access rights: The main contact person and contact persons of the coordinator with full access rights have the same level of rights: they can manage the list of participants and contacts, edit any part of the administrative part of the proposal and upload any attachments (eg. Part B - technical description), and submit the proposal. Contact persons with read-only rights can only view/download the information. Participant contacts with full access rights can only edit their section of the administrative form and view all proposal data.
Access rights can be revoked by the Coordinating Organisation contacts. The person who created the proposal cannot be deleted.

Invitation: All contacts will receive an e-mail and a notification to the Portal about the invitation to the proposal upon saving the data at Step 4 of the submission process.

Example, not to be completed

Organisation data

The section shows the administrative data of the participating organisation as registered and/or validated in the central registry of organisations of the European Commission, linked to the given PIC number. Data in blue is read-only, modification is not possible in the proposal forms. For more information on how to modify this information, please visit the online manual on the participant register.

PIC ***Legal name***

Short name

Address of the organisation

Street

Town

Postcode

Country

Webpage

Specific legal statuses

Read more about legal statuses.

Public ..... unknown

Legal person ..... unknown

Non-profit ..... unknown

International organisation ..... unknown

International organisation of European interest ..... unknown

Secondary or Higher education establishment ..... unknown

Research organisation ..... unknown

SME status

The enterprise data of the organisation is taken from the Participant Register. Changes to the self-declared or self-assessed SME data can be performed by the self-registrant or by the LEAR (Legal Entity Appointed Representative) in the Participant Register.

SME self declared status..... unknown

SME self-assessment..... unknown

SME validation sme..... unknown

Based on the above details of the Participant Registry the organisation is not an SME (small- and medium-sized enterprise) for the call.

Example, not to be completed

Departments carrying out the proposed work

The information serves mainly statistical purposes. For determining the eligibility of the proposal, the official address of the organisation is taken into account.

Department 1

Department name ☐ not applicable

☐ Same as organisation address

Street *Please enter street name and number*

Town

Postcode

Country

Example, not to be completed

Links with other participants

Please indicate if there are dependencies with other participants of the proposal.
Two participants (legal entities) are dependent on each other where there is a controlling relationship between them:
** A legal entity is under the same direct or indirect control as another legal entity;or*
** A legal entity directly or indirectly controls another legal entity;or*
** A legal entity is directly or indirectly controlled by another legal entity.Control:*

Legal entity A controls legal entity B if:
** A, directly or indirectly, holds more than 50% of the nominal value of the issued share capital or a majority of the voting rights of the shareholders or associates of B, or*
** A, directly or indirectly, holds in fact or in law the decision-making powers in B.*

The following relationships between legal entities shall not in themselves be deemed to constitute controlling relationships:
(a) the same public investment corporation, institutional investor or venture-capital company has a direct or indirect holding of more than 50 % of the nominal value of the issued share capital or a majority of voting rights of the shareholders or associates;
(b) the legal entities concerned are owned or supervised by the same public body.

Type of link	***Participant***	
*[*Same group*]* *[*Controls*]* *[*Is controlled by*]*	*Select one participant from the list of participants*	

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Main contact person

It is the main scientist or team leader in charge of the proposal for the participant. For participant number 1 (the coordinator), this will be the person the EU services will contact concerning this proposal (e.g. for additional information, invitation to hearings, sending of evaluation results, convocation to start grant agreement preparation). The data in blue is read-only. Details (name, first name and e-mail) of Main Contact persons should be edited in Step 4 of the Submission wizard.

Title Gender ○ Woman ○ Man ○ Non binary

First name Last name

E-mail

Position in org. *Please indicate the position of the person*

Department ☐ Same as organisation

☐ Same as organisation address

Street

Town Post code

Country

Website

Phone 1 Phone 2

Example, not to be completed

Other contact persons

First name	Last name	e-mail	Phone

Researchers involved in the proposal

Include only the researchers involved in the proposal, (see below definition of 'researcher'). You do not need to include in the table the identity of other persons involved in the proposal who are not researchers.

'Researchers are professionals engaged in the conception or creation of new knowledge. They conduct research and improve or develop concepts, theories, models, techniques instrumentation, software or operational methods. (Frascati Manual 2015)'

Include also person in charge of the proposal if a researcher

Title	First Name	Last Name	Gender	Nationality	E-mail	Career stage[1]	Role of researcher (in the project)	Reference Identifier	Type of identifier
			*[*Woman*]* *[*Man*]* *[*Non-binary*]*			*[*Category A – Top grade researcher*]* *[*Category B – Senior researcher*]* *[*Category C – Recognised researcher*]* *[*Category D – First stage researcher*]*	*[*Leading*]* *[*Team member*]*		*[*ORCID*]* *[*Researcher Id*]* *[*Other - specify*]*

Example, not to be completed

[1] Career stages as defined in Frascati 2015 manual:
Category A – Top grade researcher: the single highest grade/post at which research is normally conducted. Example: 'Full professor' or 'Director of research'.
Category B – Senior researcher: Researchers working in positions not as senior as top position but more senior than newly qualified doctoral graduates (IsCED level 8). Examples: 'associate professor' or 'senior researcher' or 'principal investigator'.
Category C – Recognised researcher: the first grade/post into which a newly qualified doctoral graduate would normally be recruited. Examples: 'assistant professor', 'investigator' or 'post-doctoral fellow'.
Category D – First stage researcher: Either doctoral students at the IsCED level 8 who are engaged as researchers, or researchers working in posts that do not normally require a doctorate degree. Examples: 'PhD students' or 'junior researchers' (without a PhD).

Role of participating organisation in the project *Applicants may select more than one option.*		*Definitions*
Project management	☐	*Click if your organisation will do project management activities (i.e. assigning the tasks, reporting and interface with the EC). These tasks are normally carried out by the coordinator, but other participants can also contribute.*
Communication, dissemination and engagement	☐	*Click if your organisation will be in charge of communication, dissemination and engagement. This can be centralised by one partner or split across the partners.*
Provision of research and technology infrastructure	☐	*Click if your organisation is providing a research facility or research equipment.*
Co-definition of research and market needs	☐	*Click if your organisation will be involved in the co-defining the research and market needs. Usually it is a company that intends to later use the research results, or a NGO that will use the solution. This will help the project further tailor its results to respond to specific needs of the end user.*
Civil society representative	☐	*Click if your organisation belongs to civil society (NGO, association, organisation, consumer group, community group, charity, etc.).*
Policy maker or regulator, incl. standardisation body	☐	*Click if your organisation is a policy maker (local, regional, national, European level), regulator or a standardisation body.*
Research performer	☐	*Click if your organisation is in charge of performing the research during the project.*
Technology developer	☐	*Click if your organisation is in charge of developing the technology during or after the project.*
Testing/validation of approaches and ideas	☐	*Click if your organisation is in charge of testing/validating the approach and ideas.*
Prototyping and demonstration	☐	*Click if your organisation is in charge of developing the prototypes and performing demonstrations.*
IPR management incl. technology transfer	☐	*Click if your organisation is in charge of IPR management including technology transfer at the end of the grant.*
Public procurer of results	☐	*Click if your organisation (public authority, hospital, university, local government, etc) will be using the results afterwards.*
Private buyer of results	☐	*Click if your organisation (from the private sector) will be using the results afterwards.*
Finance provider (public or private)	☐	*Click if your organisation will be providing the financing for the exploitation during or after the end of the project.*
Education and training	☐	*Click if your organisation is in charge of educating and training researchers.*
Contributions from the social sciences or/and the humanities	☐	*Click if your organisation is in charge of contributing to the social sciences or/and the humanities dimension to the research projec.t*
Other Specify (50 character limit):	☐	

Example, not to be completed

List of up to 5 publications, widely-used datasets, software, goods, services, or any other achievements relevant to the call content.

Type of achievement	**Short description**
*[*Publication*]* *[*Dataset*]* *[*Software*]*	Key elements of the achievement, including a short qualitative assessment of its impact and (where available) its digital object identifier (DOI) or other type of persistent identifier (PID). Publications, in particular journal articles, are expected to be open access. Datasets are expected to be FAIR and 'as open as possible, as closed as necessary'.

*[*Good*]* *[*Service*]* *[*Other achievement*]*	

List of up to 5 most relevant previous projects or activities, connected to the subject of this proposal

Name of Project or Activity	**Short description**

Description of any significant infrastructure and/or any major items of technical equipment, relevant to the proposed work

Name of infrastructure or equipment	**Short description**

Example, not to be completed

Gender equality plan

Having a gender equality plan is an eligibility criterion for Public bodies, Higher education establishments and Research organisations from Member States and Associated Countries. Be aware that if the proposal is selected, having a Gender Equality Plan will be necessary before the grant agreement signature (applicable on calls with deadlines in 2022 and beyond). Does the organisation have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) covering the elements listed below? **Minimum process-related requirements (building blocks) for a GEP** – **Publication:** formal document published on the institution's website and signed by the top management. – **Dedicated resources:** commitment of human resources and gender expertise to implement it.	○ Yes	○ No

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– **Data collection and monitoring:** sex/gender disaggregated data on personnel (and students for establishments concerned) and annual reporting based on indicators. – **Training:** Awareness raising/trainings on gender equality and unconscious gender biases for staff and decision-makers. **Content-wise, recommended areas** to be **covered** and addressed via concrete measures and targets are: ○ work-life balance and organisational culture; ○ gender balance in leadership and decision-making; ○ gender equality in recruitment and career progression; ○ integration of the gender dimension into research and teaching content; ○ measures against gender-based violence including sexual harassment.		

Example, not to be completed

3 – Budget for the proposal

No	Name of the Beneficiary	Country	Role	Requested grant amount
1				
			Total	

Example, not to be completed

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4 – Ethics and Security

Ethics issues table

This table should be completed as an essential part of your proposal. Please go through the table and indicate which elements concern your proposal by answering 'Yes' or 'No'. If you answer 'Yes' to any of the questions,

- *indicate in the adjacent box at which page in your technical description further information relating to that ethics issue can be found, and*
- *provide additional information on that ethics issue in the Ethics Self-Assessment section.*

For more information on each of the ethics issues and how to address them, including detailed legal references, see the guidelines 'How to Complete your Ethics Self-Assessment'.

1. HUMAN EMBRYONIC STEM CELLS AND HUMAN EMBRYOS			Page
Does this activity involve Human Embryonic Stem Cells (hESCs)?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Will they be directly derived from embryos within this project?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they previously established cells lines?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are the cell lines registered in the European registry for human embryonic stem cell lines?	○ Yes ○ No	
Does this activity involve the use of human embryos?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Will the activity lead to their destruction?	○ Yes ○ No	
2. HUMANS			Page
Does this activity involve human participants?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Are they volunteers for non medical studies (e.g. social or human sciences research)?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they healthy volunteers for medical studies?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they patients for medical studies?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they potentially vulnerable individuals or groups?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they children/minors?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they other persons unable to give informed consent?	○ Yes ○ No	
Does this activity involve interventions (physical also including imaging technology, behavioural treatments, etc.) on the study participants?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Does it involve invasive techniques?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Does it involve collection of biological samples?	○ Yes ○ No	

Example, not to be completed

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Does this activity involve conducting a clinical study as defined by the Clinical Trial Regulation (EU 536/2014)? (using pharmaceuticals, biologicals, radiopharmaceuticals, or advanced therapy medicinal products)		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Is it a clinical trial?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Is it a low-intervention clinical trial?	○ Yes ○ No	
3. HUMAN CELLS / TISSUES (not covered by section 1)			Page
Does this activity involve the use of human cells or tissues?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Are they human embryonic or foetal cells or tissues?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they available commercially?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they obtained within this project?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they obtained from another project, laboratory or institution?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they obtained from biobank?	○ Yes ○ No	
4. PERSONAL DATA			Page
Does this activity involve processing of personal data?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Does it involve the processing of special categories of personal data (e.g.: sexual lifestyle, ethnicity, genetic, biometric and health data, political opinion, religious or philosophical beliefs)?	○ Yes ○ No	
	If **YES**: Does it involve processing of genetic, biometric or health data?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Does it involve profiling, systematic monitoring of individuals, or processing of large scale of special categories of data or intrusive methods of data processing (such as, surveillance, geolocation tracking etc.)?	○ Yes ○ No	
Does this activity involve further processing of previously collected personal data (including use of preexisting data sets or sources, merging existing data sets)?		○ Yes ○ No	
Is it planned to export personal data from the EU to non-EU countries?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Specify the type of personal data and countries involved:		
Is it planned to import personal data from non-EU countries into the EU or from a non-EU country to another non-EU country?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Specify the type of personal data and countries involved		

Example, not to be completed

Does this activity involve the processing of personal data related to criminal convictions or offences?		○ Yes ○ No	
5. ANIMALS			Page
Does this activity involve animals?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Are they vertebrates?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they non-human primates (NHP)?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they genetically modified?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they cloned farm animals?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Are they endangered species?	○ Yes ○ No	
6. NON-EU COUNTRIES			Page
Will some of the activities be carried out in non-EU countries?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Specify the countries:		
In case non-EU countries are involved, do the activities undertaken in these countries raise potential ethics issues?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Specify the countries:		
Is it planned to use local resources (e.g. animal and/or human tissue samples, genetic material, live animals, human remains, materials of historical value, endangered fauna or flora samples, etc.)?		○ Yes ○ No	
Is it planned to import any material from non-EU countries into the EU or from a non-EU country to another non-EU country? For data imports, see section 4.		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Specify material and countries involved:		
Is it planned to export any material from the EU to non-EU countries?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Specify material and countries involved:		
Does this activity involves low and/or lower-middle income countries? (if yes, detail the benefit-sharing actions planned in the self-assessment)		○ Yes ○ No	
Could the situation in the country put the individuals taking part in the activity at risk?		○ Yes ○ No	
7. ENVIRONMENT, HEALTH and SAFETY			Page

Example, not to be completed

Does this activity involve the use of substances or processes that may cause harm to the environment, to animals or plants (during the implementation of the activity or further to the use of the results, as a possible impact)?	○ Yes ○ No	
Does this activity deal with endangered fauna and/or flora / protected areas?	○ Yes ○ No	
Does this activity involve the use of substances or processes that may cause harm to humans, including those performing them (during the implementation of the activity or further to the use of the results, as a possible impact)?	○ Yes ○ No	
8. ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE		Page
Does this activity involve the development, deployment and/or use of Artificial Intelligence based systems? (if yes, detail in the self-assessment whether that could raise ethical concerns related to human rights and values and detail how this will be addressed).	○ Yes ○ No	
9. OTHER ETHICS ISSUES		Page
Are there any other ethics issues that should be taken into consideration?	○ Yes ○ No	
Please specify: (Maximum number of characters allowed: 1000)		

I confirm that I have taken into account all ethics issues above and that, if any ethics issues apply, I will complete the ethics self-assessment as described in the guidelines 'How to Complete your Ethics Self-Assessment'. ☐

Example, not to be completed

ETHICS SELF-ASSESSMENT

If you have entered any issues in the ethics issue table, you must perform an ethics self-assessment in accordance with the guidelines "How to Complete your Ethics Self-Assessment" and complete the table below.

Ethical dimension of the objectives, methodology and likely impact
Explain in detail the identified issues in relation to: – objectives of the activities (e.g. study of vulnerable populations, etc.) – methodology (e.g. clinical trials, involvement of children, protection of personal data, etc.) – the potential impact of the activities (e.g. environmental damage, stigmatisation of particular social groups, political or financial adverse consequences, misuse, etc.)
Compliance with ethical principles and relevant legislations
Describe how the issue(s) identified in the ethics issues table above will be addressed in order to adhere to the ethical principles and what will be done to ensure that the activities are compliant with the E U / national legal and ethical requirements of the country or countries where the tasks are to be carried out. It is reminded that for **activities performed in a non-EU countries**, they should also be allowed in at least one EU Member State.

Example, not to be completed

Security issues table

Please go through the table and indicate which elements concern your proposal by answering YES or NO.
If you answer YES to any of the questions:

- *indicate in the adjacent box at which page in your full proposal further information relating to that security issue can be found, and*
- *provide additional information on this security issue in the Security self-assessment section below.*

For more information on potential security issues and how to address them, see the guidance How to handle security-sensitive projects and the programme-specific guidelines Classification of information in Horizon Europe projects.

1. EU classified information (EUCI)[2]			Page
Does this activity involve information and/or materials requiring protection against unauthorised disclosure (EUCI)?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Is the activity going to use classified information as background[3] information?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Is the activity going to generate EU classified foreground[4] information as results?	○ Yes ○ No	
Does this activity involve participants from non-EU countries which need to have access to EUCI?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Do the non-EU countries concerned have a security of information agreement with the EU?	○ Yes ○ No	
2. MISUSE			**Page**
Does this activity have the potential for misuse of results?		○ Yes ○ No	
If **YES**:	Does the activity provide knowledge, materials and technologies that could be channelled into crime and/or terrorism?	○ Yes ○ No	
	Could the activity result in the development of chemical, biological, radiological or nuclear (CBRN) weapons and the means for their delivery?	○ Yes ○ No	
3. OTHER SECURITY ISSUES			**Page**
Does this activity involve information and/or materials subject to national security restrictions?		○ Yes ○ No	
If yes, please specify: *(Maximum number of characters allowed: 1000)*			
Are there any other security issues that should be taken into consideration?		○ Yes ○ No	

Example - not to be completed

[2] According to the Commission Decision (EU, Euratom) 2015/444 of 13 March 2015 on the security rules for protecting EU classified information, "European Union classified information (EUCI) means any information or material designated by an EU security classification, the unauthorised disclosure of which could cause varying degrees of prejudice to the interests of the European Union or of one or more of the Member States".

[3] Classified background information is information that is already classified by a country and/or international organisation and/or the EU and is going to be used by the project. In this case, the project must have in advance the authorisation from the originator of the classified information, which is the entity (EU institution, EU Member State, third state or international organisation) under whose authority the classified information has been generated.

[4] EU classified foreground information is information (documents/deliverables/materials) planned to be generated by the project and that needs to be protected from unauthorised disclosure. The originator of the EUCI generated by the project is the European Commission.

If yes, please specify: (Maximum number of characters allowed: 1000)	

SECURITY SELF-ASSESSMENT

If you have answered YES for one or more of the questions indicated above, describe the measures you intend to take to solve/avoid them. For more information, see the guidelines Classification of information in Horizon Europe projects, Classification of information in Digital Europe projects, Classification of information in EDF projects.

Please specify *(Maximum number of characters allowed: 5000)*

5 – Other questions

Two-stage calls

The full stage-2 proposal must be consistent with the short outline proposal submitted to the stage 1 – in particular with respect to the proposal characteristics addressing the concepts of excellence and impact.

Are there substantial differences compared to the stage-1 proposal?	○ Yes	○ No

Questions showed only in answer is Yes:

Please list the substantial differences, and indicate the reasons

☐	Partnership	*List the substantial differences and indicate the reasons*
☐	Budget	*List the substantial differences and indicate the reasons*
☐	Approach	*List the substantial differences and indicate the reasons*

Example, not to be completed

[Additional modular extension for Calls with clinical trials: Essential information to be provided for proposals including clinical trials / studies / investigations

Clinical study means, for the purpose of this document, any systematic prospective or retrospective collection and analysis of health data obtained from individual patients or healthy persons in order to address scientific questions related to the understanding, prevention, diagnosis, monitoring or treatment of a disease, mental illness, or physical condition. It includes but it is not limited to clinical studies as defined by Regulation 536/2014 (on medicinal products), clinical investigation and clinical evaluation as defined by Regulation 2017/745 (on medical devices), performance study and performance evaluation as defined by Regulation 2017/746 (on in vitro diagnostic medical devices.

Are clinical studies / trials / investigations included in the work plan of this project?	○ Yes	○ No

Please upload the dedicated annex 'Essential information for clinical studies / trials / investigations' (a Word template is provided under 'download templates' in the up-load section for Part B and Annexes).

This document should include the relevant information of each clinical study / trial / investigation included in the work plan of this project.

Please give a short title, an acronym or a unique identifier to each clinical study / trial / investigation, to be used as a reference / identifier in the other parts of the proposal	Add / Remove

]

[Additional modular extension for EIC accelerator calls:

Please select a Funding type	*[*Grant Only*]* *[*Equity Only*]* *[*Blended Finance*]*

What is the gender of the CEO?	○ Woman	○ Man	○ Non binary	○ We don't have this position
What is the gender of the CSO?	○ Woman	○ Man	○ Non binary	○ We don't have this position
What is the gender of the CTO?	○ Woman	○ Man	○ Non binary	○ We don't have this position

Example, not to be completed

Your relations with the Granting Authority and the jury or the evaluation of your proposal will not be affected if you do not consent to the sharing of information, including personal data, as indicated below. You have the right to withdraw consent at any moment by contacting the Data Controller at EISMEA-ENQUIRIES@ec.europa.eu. The withdrawal of your consent will not affect the lawfulness of the personal data processing operations that took place before the withdrawal.

☐	**Consent 1:** In case my proposal will be selected for support through an investment component, I give my consent for the Commission, EISMEA and the EIC Fund to share necessary information, including personal data (first and last name, phone number, and email address) with the other actors involved in the management of the action: the Alternative Investment Manager of the EIC Fund and the European Investment Bank. I understand that the EIC Fund and/or the Business Acceleration Services may also help look for additional investors and that my consent will be asked before other investors are contacted or engaged.
☐	**Consent 2:** I agree to share a limited set of my personal data (first and last name, phone number, and email address) with the EIC National Contact Points, Enterprise Europe Network and funding bodies that recognise and support Seal of Excellence projects, in addition to information related to the proposal (its acronym, title, abstract, and amount of requested grant and/or investment). The sharing of information, including personal data, will happen only for the purpose of Seal of Excellence which might be awarded to my proposal, assessed to meet the relevant evaluation criteria, but which will not be directly funded by the EIC.

]

Project proposal – Technical description (Part B)

Example, not to be completed



Example, not to be completed

Horizon Europe Programme

Standard Application Form
EIC Strategic Technologies for Europe Platform (STEP) Scale Up Call

Project proposal – Technical description (Part B)

Version 1.0
8 November 2024

Structure of the Proposal

The proposal contains two parts:

- **Part A** of the proposal **is generated by the IT system. It is based on the information entered by participants within the submission system in the Funding & Tenders Portal.** Participants can update the information in the submission system at any time before final submission of the proposal.

- **Part B** of the proposal is the narrative part that includes different sections covering the different evaluation criteria. Part B needs to be uploaded as a PDF document using the templates that can be downloaded in the submission system for the specific call or topic.

The electronic submission system is an online step-by-step guide through the preparation of your proposal. The submission process consists of 6 steps:

- Step 1: Logging in the Portal
- Step 2: Select the call, topic and type of action in the Portal
- Step 3: Create a draft proposal: Title, acronym, summary, main organisation and contact details
- Step 4: Manage your parties and contact details: add your partner organisations and contact details.
- Step 5: Edit and complete web forms for proposal part A and upload proposal part B
- Step 6: Submit the proposal

HISTORY OF CHANGES		
Version	**Publication date**	**Changes**
1.0	01.11.2024	• Initial version

Example, not to be completed

Proposal template Part B: technical description

The structure of this template must be followed when preparing your proposal. It has been designed to ensure that the important aspects of your planned work are presented in a way that will enable the experts to make an effective assessment against the evaluation criteria.

Please be aware that proposals will be evaluated as they were submitted, rather than on their potential if certain changes were to be made. This means that only proposals that successfully address all the required aspects will have a chance of being funded. There will be no possibility for significant changes to content, budget and consortium composition during grant preparation.

Maximum page limit: The maximum page limit is 50 pages (including the cover page). At the time of submission, you can remove the text on the structure of the proposal, the history of changes, the technical description, the table of content and the instructions (including the list of annexes). Please keep the headings.

If you attempt to upload a proposal longer than the specified limit before the deadline, you will receive an automatic warning and will be advised to shorten and re-upload the proposal. After the deadline, excess pages (in over-long proposals/applications) will be automatically made invisible and will not be taken into consideration by the experts. The proposal is a self-contained document. Experts will be instructed to ignore hyperlinks to information that is specifically designed to expand the proposal.

The following formatting conditions apply.

The reference font for the body text of proposals is Times New Roman (Windows platforms), Times/Times New Roman (Apple platforms) or Nimbus Roman No. 9 L (Linux distributions).

The use of a different font for the body text is not advised and is subject to the cumulative conditions that the font is legible and that its use does not significantly shorten the representation of the proposal in number of pages compared to using the reference font (for example with a view to bypass the page limit).

The minimum font size allowed is 11 points. Standard character spacing and a minimum of single line spacing is to be used. This applies to the body text, including text in tables.

Text elements other than the body text, such as headers, foot/end notes, captions, formula's, may deviate, but must be legible.

The page size is A4, and all margins (top, bottom, left, right) should be at least 15 mm (not including any footers or headers).

Example, not to be completed

Guidance on the use of generative AI tools for the preparation of the proposal
When considering the use of generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools for the preparation of the proposal, it is imperative to exercise caution and careful consideration. The AI-generated content should be thoroughly reviewed and validated by the applicants to ensure its appropriateness and accuracy, as well as its compliance with intellectual property regulations. Applicants are fully responsible for the content of the proposal (even those parts produced by the AI tool) and must be transparent in disclosing which AI tools were used and how they were utilized. Specifically, applicants are required to: • Verify the accuracy, validity, and appropriateness of the content and any citations generated by the AI tool and correct any errors or inconsistencies. • Provide a list of sources used to generate content and citations, including those generated by the AI tool. Double-check citations to ensure they are accurate and properly referenced. • Be conscious of the potential for plagiarism where the AI tool may have reproduced substantial text from other sources. Check the original sources to be sure you are not plagiarizing someone else's work. • Acknowledge the limitations of the AI tool in the proposal preparation, including the potential for bias, errors, and gaps in knowledge.

The structure of the part B is shown below in the left column, you can see the related evaluation criteria in the right column.

Part B – Table of content		**Main evaluation criteria addressed**
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY		
PART 1 – BUSINESS CASE		
1	COMPANY DESCRIPTION	EXCELLENCE
2	THE PROBLEM/OPPORTUNITY	
3	THE INNOVATION: SOLUTION/ PRODUCT OR SERVICES (USP)	
4	MARKET ANALYSIS AND COMPETITION ANALYSIS	IMPACT
5	MARKETING AND SALES PLAN	
6	TEAM AND GOVERNANCE	LEVEL OF RISK, IMPLEMENTATION AND NEED FOR UNION SUPPORT
7	RISKS	
8	FINANCIAL AND SCALE UP PLAN	
PART 2 – EIC SPECIFIC INFORMATION		
9	HOW EU SUPPORT TAKES THE COMPANY TO THE NEXT VALUE POINT	LEVEL OF RISK, IMPLEMENTATION AND NEED FOR UNION SUPPORT
10	IMPACT	IMPACT

Example, not to be completed

⚠ *Fill in the title of your proposal below.*

TITLE OF THE PROPOSAL

List of participants

Participant	Participant organisation name	Country
1 (Coordinator)		
2 Affiliated entity(ies), if any. Please explain the link with the coordinator and the role in the project.		

Which of the priority areas defined in the STEP Regulation[1] does your innovation relate to? Please indicate in the text box below:

Priority Area	Yes/No	Specific Technology(ies)
Digital technologies and deep tech innovations		
Clean and resource efficient technologies		
Biotechnologies		

Example, not to be completed

Executive Summary

Prepare an executive summary of maximum 2 pages.

[1] Regulation - EU - 2024/795 - EN - EUR-Lex (europa.eu), Article 2(1), point (a) of the STEP Regulation

Part 1 – Business case

1. Company description

- **Mission and vision**: explain the core mission and vision of your company and your ambition to scale up. Explain how the company's core purpose aligns with the EU's strategic goals, particularly in the relevant Priority Area. Focus on how the company's activities are critical to the EU's technological sovereignty and the STEP initiative.
- **Key partners and contributions:** explain who the key partners and their expected contributions are (e.g. a first lead customer, a university, potential user groups, partners for clinical trials, etc.).
- **Assets and resources**: detail the company's assets, including IP, R&D facilities, offices, laboratories, and access to critical resources like manufacturing capabilities.
- **Top Clients, Suppliers, and Advisors:** to the extend applicable, list the company's top 3 to 5 clients, key suppliers, and advisors. Provide details on their contributions to the business and how they support the company's growth. Highlight the share of revenue from the top clients, the share of Cost of Goods Sold (COGS) or operational expenses (OPEX) from key suppliers, and the role of advisors in providing strategic support.

2. The problem/opportunity

- **Problem definition**
  - Describe the problem you have identified and explain why it is a problem and for whom.
  - Describe the unsatisfied need of potential customers.

3. The innovation: Solution/Product or Services (USP)

- **Overview of the solution:** explain in simple terms and with graphs if needed, how your solution works, its main features and what key areas are still subject to improvements/innovation. Describe your innovation, focusing on how it addresses the identified problem or opportunity. Highlight the unique and breakthrough elements of your solution.
- **Value proposition:** provide evidence on how it is superior to existing solutions and why now is the right time for its market introduction.
- **Development stage, Technology Readiness:** Describe your technological achievements so far; specify which Technology Readiness Level this has attained; and describe to what extent your solution has been validated/certified and by whom. Please explain using a case study[2] (test, pilot, PoC, etc.). For health companies, explain the specifics of what clinical trials you have conducted, if any, and to what level. Elaborate on the development roadmap including foreseen timeline.
- **Intellectual Property Strategy:** explain your intellectual property (IP) strategy, including any patents held, their registration status, and any licenses acquired. Explain how you ensure your freedom to operate and provide supporting documents in the mandatory annex "Results of the freedom to operate Analysis".

Example, not to be completed

[2] You should explain who it was for, how much they were paid, what is the environment in which the case study was performed (background, context, and physical environment), what was the problem, what metrics were associated with the problem, what did the solution bring to solve this, how did the metrics evolve with the solution, and if/how is the client looking to deploy it internally.

4. Market analysis and competition analysis

- **Market potential**: Define the market in terms of Total Addressable Market (TAM); Serviceable Available Market (SAM); Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM); and market growth (Compounded Annual Growth Rate (CAGR))[3].
- **Willingness to pay and customer demand**: provide evidence of demand for your innovation, particularly from European customers. List POCs and pilots run with users and clients.
- **Competitors & Differentiation:** Identify competitors, both within and outside the EU. Whay are their solutions' limitations and potential advantages compared to what is offered by your expected solution?

5. Marketing and sales plan

- **Business model**: Describe your business model, including how the company generates revenue and scale: key sales activities, resources, customer relationships, channels, pricing policy, geographical markets. Upload any letter of intent as a separate annex, if relevant.
- **Go-to-Market Strategy:** Outline your go-to-market plan, including key milestones to reach the critical sales level (such as EUR 100m in sales). Identify who are the key distributors and/or customers that will allow the company to scale, your customer pipeline, and sales funnel. Discuss any barriers to market entry within the EU and how you plan to overcome them. Emphasize the potential for significant growth and scaling within the EU market.

6. Team and governance

- **Management Team**: Present your core management team, including founders and key personnel. Highlight their experience and expertise in leading strategic technology ventures. Explain how you plan to ensure gender balance among your team members, including those in executive positions (at least CEO, CSO and CTO).

Team Member (Name and Surname)	Gender (man/woman/non binary)	Founder (Y/N)	Position - department	Key competences	Commitment (from 1% to 100%)

Example, not to be completed

- **Skills and Gaps**: describe any skills or competencies that are currently missing withing the team and provide a plan to address these gaps, including recruitment and employee retention strategies. Discuss the company's approach to ensuring gender balance in executive roles.
- **Governance**: provide an overview of your board of directors, consultants and advisors, and explain their added value and defined role in the project.
- Do you have an Employee Stock Ownership Plan (ESOP) in place to incentivise key non-founding members of your team?
- Detail your capitalization table.

Name	Type (founder, investor, other)	% fully diluted

[3] Please ensure that these figures are correlated to your business plan revenue projections and can be tied to the client landscape and go to market strategy (in particular the SOM).

TOTAL		100%

7. Risks

- **Risk Analysis**: Identify the key risks that could impact your innovation's success, including technological, IP, financial, regulatory and market risks. Explain how each of these risks could affect the company's ability to scale within the EU.
- **Risk Mitigation**: for each identified risk, outline the steps you will take to mitigate or minimize its impact. Include specific strategies for overcoming barriers to entry or scaling in the EU, as well as plans to address potential challenges related to market dependencies.

8. Financial and scale up plan

- **Funding request:** Clearly specify the amount of equity-only funding requested (between EUR 10–30 million). Justify why this specific amount is required, and how it will be used.
- **Financial Projections**: Describe your main hypothesis supporting figures in the mandatory annex "Financial plan and equity needed", e.g. the projection of your turnover, the important capex and the main elements of your costs of goods sold. Use this space to comment on the figures shown in the excel table.
- **Scale-up funding strategy**: List the main milestones to achieve the company's vision to scale up, as explained in section 1 and in relation to section 5. Provide a high-level overview of your company's current and future funding strategy to raise additional funding rounds until reaching breakeven. Explain how EIC funding will support you in achieving key business and technical milestones, which will in turn unlock further private investments from European or international investors. Detail your strategy for attracting further private investment, ensuring that the EIC funding acts as a catalyst for larger funding rounds (at least 3-5 times the EIC contribution). Discuss any pre-commitments from investors.

Example, not to be completed

Part 2 – EIC Specific information

9. How EU support takes the company to the next value point

- **Challenges in securing market financing**: Explain why you have not been able to raise sufficient investment to scale your company. Identify the specific risks or barriers (e.g., high technological risk, market uncertainty) that prevent private investors from fully committing at this stage.
- **Catalytic role of EU Funding**: Describe how EIC STEP Scale Up funding will act as a catalyst for your company's growth, attracting additional private investors. Detail how this funding will help close a significant funding gap, allowing your company to scale rapidly in critical European technology sectors. Elaborate on how the EIC funding will benefit the development of your innovation and scalability of your business.
- **Funding strategy**: What is your overall funding strategy for the next 3-5 years and what is the role the EIC Fund shall play. Detail the milestones identified in section 3 and 5 that you believe will trigger the next rounds and interest of new investors.
- **Exit Strategy, Timeline, and Return on Investment**: describe your exit strategy, including the timeline for achieving it and the expected return on investment (ROI) for an investment at this stage. Provide

assumptions behind the ROI, such as market growth, adoption rates, and potential acquisition or public listing scenarios. Highlight how this aligns with both company and investor expectations.
- Companies must explain if they are a subsidiary of another company (parent or holding) which is established in the territory of a Member State or Associated Country and itself eligible for EIC Accelerator support, and if the intended investment should in their view take place in the parent company or holding. This will also be declared in the mandatory "Ownership control declaration" form.

10. Impact

- Describe the societal, economic, environmental and/or climate impact of your proposal.
- Describe your company's potential to create jobs each year for the next 5 years, including indirect jobs if applicable.
- Explain how your proposal contributes to the UN Sustainable Development Goals.

STEP Impact
- Describe how your application fits within the scope of one of the priority areas defined in the STEP regulation.
- Describe how your innovation will have a clear and measurable positive impact on the EU Single Market, either by:
    - Strengthening its competitiveness: how the innovation addresses a critical need within the EU internal market, fostering innovation and technological leadership for European companies.
      or
    - Reducing strategic dependencies: how the innovation contributes to reducing the EU's reliance on non-EU sources for critical technologies or raw materials.

(Note: applicants from Associated Countries will need to demonstrate contributions to the EU internal market or strategic dependencies)

Example, not to be completed

Declarations

These declarations are without prejudice to the Declaration of Honour that selected applicants are requested to sign before entering into any legal commitment.

1. By applying to the EIC Accelerator Programme, you and your company declare that natural persons and Ultimate Beneficial Owners are not listed on sanctions lists and moreover undertake not to do business with customers, or make funds or economic resources available to, or for the benefit of (directly or indirectly) any natural or legal person designated under EU sanctions EU Sanctions Map.

2. Moreover, you and your company declare that entities subject to EU restrictive measures under Article 29 of the Treaty on the European Union (TEU) and Article 215 of the Treaty on the Functioning of the EU (TFEU) as well as Article 75 TFEU will not participate in any capacity in the action, including as beneficiaries, affiliated entities, associated partners, third parties giving in-kind contributions, subcontractors or recipients of financial support to third parties (if any) - http://www.sanctionsmap.eu.

3. In addition, you and your company undertake not to enter into consultations with a view to adopt remedial measures if one of the company's business partners is designated under EU sanctions or makes funds or economic resources available to, or for the benefit of, directly or indirectly, a person subject to EU sanctions.

Example not to be completed

ANNEXES TO PROPOSAL PART B

Please upload the following documents. The annexes must be uploaded as separate documents in the submission system. For some of them, standard templates are published in the Horizon Europe Funding & Tenders portal:

Mandatory

- **Pitch deck**. There is no pre-defined template but there is a limit of 15 slides. Please keep in mind that you will have 10 minutes to present this pitch deck if you are invited to the face-to-face interviews. The pitch deck should be provided in PDF file format.
- **Financial plan and consent**. Please use the template provided.
- **Results of the freedom to operate (FTO) analysis.** If you do not have one, please upload a note of maximum 2 pages outlining your freedom to operate and providing as much information as possible on this issue. In cases where the FTO is not relevant (e.g. software), please upload a simple statement.
- **Pre-commitment from a qualified investor.** Please use the template provided**.**
- **CVs of key personnel**. Please merge them all in one pdf document.
- **Letters of intent**. Please merge them all in one pdf document.
- **Ownership control declaration**. Please use the template provided.